

MOCK CLIENT BRIEF · MEDIA & PERFORMANCE STRATEGY

# Winning the Next 10 Million Users

Closing Swiggy Instamart's user-base gap with the category leader | A full-funnel media plan for 18–30 urban India

**The “10 million” story:** Instamart stands at 13.3M average MTU (Q4 FY26); Blinkit is at 27M+. This deck is the media plan to close that gap, funnel by funnel.

Prepared as: **Media Planning Deck (Client presentation)**

Category: **Quick Commerce / Instant Grocery Delivery, India**

*Independent portfolio case study · Not an official Swiggy / Instamart document · All figures cited from public filings & industry reports*

# What This Deck Covers

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# The Business Problem

## THE BRIEF, AS GIVEN

*“Grow monthly new-user acquisition among 18–30-year-olds across India's top 8 cities by 25% quarter-on-quarter ahead of the FY27 festive quarter — while holding blended CAC at or below ₹180, and lifting Day-30 repeat-order rate by 5pp.”*

## WHY NOW

- Blinkit has pulled decisively ahead, overtaking Zomato food delivery to become Eternal's single largest business; this is now a share war, not a category-creation game.
- Swiggy's group ad & promotion spend already jumped 55% YoY to ₹4,207 crore in FY26. Quick commerce only just reached contribution breakeven. Undisciplined CAC is no longer affordable.
- The festive quarter (Oct–Dec) is when quick commerce now captures a fast-growing share of category-wide festive shopping. It is the highest-leverage moment to convert fence-sitters into first-time users.

**TOP 8 CITIES IN SCOPE:** Delhi NCR • Mumbai • Bengaluru • Hyderabad • Chennai • Pune • Kolkata • Ahmedabad

## THE CENTRAL TENSION

**Grow fast.  
Stay efficient.  
Both at once.**

It is a precision-acquisition brief where the idea is to find and convert the measurably highest-value cohort, in the highest-leverage cities, in the highest-leverage quarter

## SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

**+25% QoQ new users • CAC ≤ ₹180 • +5pp D30 repeat rate**

# The Business Problem, By the Numbers

*Every number in the brief on the previous slide is derived from a real, cited gap — not picked as a round target.*

## 13.3M vs 27M+

### THE SCALE GAP

Instamart's average MTU stood at 13.3M in Q4 FY26 (up from 9.8M a year earlier). Blinkit added 3.6M MTUs in that same quarter alone, taking its own base past 27M — more than double Instamart's.

*Source: Storyboard18; The Ken*

## 3M → 0.5M / qtr

### THE STALLED ENGINE

At its peak, Instamart was adding close to 3 million new users a quarter. By Q4 FY26 that had collapsed to just ~0.5 million/quarter — despite continued marketing investment. This is the acquisition brief's actual trigger.

*Source: Storyboard18*

## 26.2M → 60.6M

### THE OPPORTUNITY

India's quick-commerce user base is projected to grow from 26.2M (2024) to 60.6M by 2029, roughly 34M incremental category users up for grabs industry-wide, mostly urban and under 30.

*Source: Vocal/Journal quick-commerce research*

## +55% YoY spend

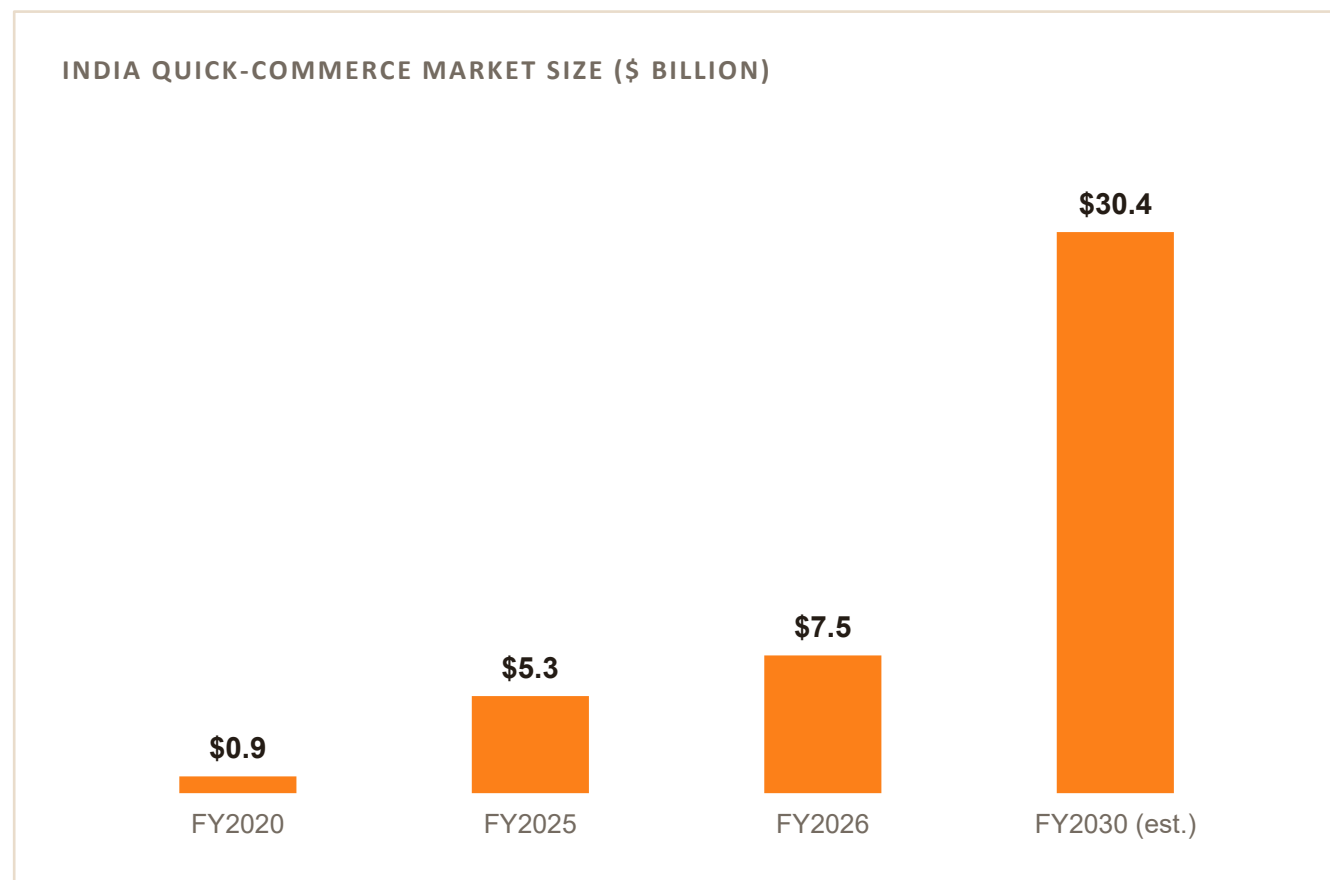
### THE CONSTRAINT

Swiggy's group ad & promotion spend rose 55% YoY to ₹4,207 crore in FY26, even as quick commerce only just crossed contribution breakeven. The brief is not “spend more”, it is “spend smarter.”

*Source: Swiggy FY26 shareholder letter*

*The read-across: Instamart doesn't need a bigger budget. It needs to reverse a specific, measured collapse in new-user velocity, in the highest-value cohort, without breaking CAC discipline.*

# The Category Is Big, Young, and Compounding



**~₹11,000 cr**

quick-commerce GMV in a single month (Jan '26), roughly double YoY

**7.8M**

orders placed per day across the category (Redseer)

**40–45%**

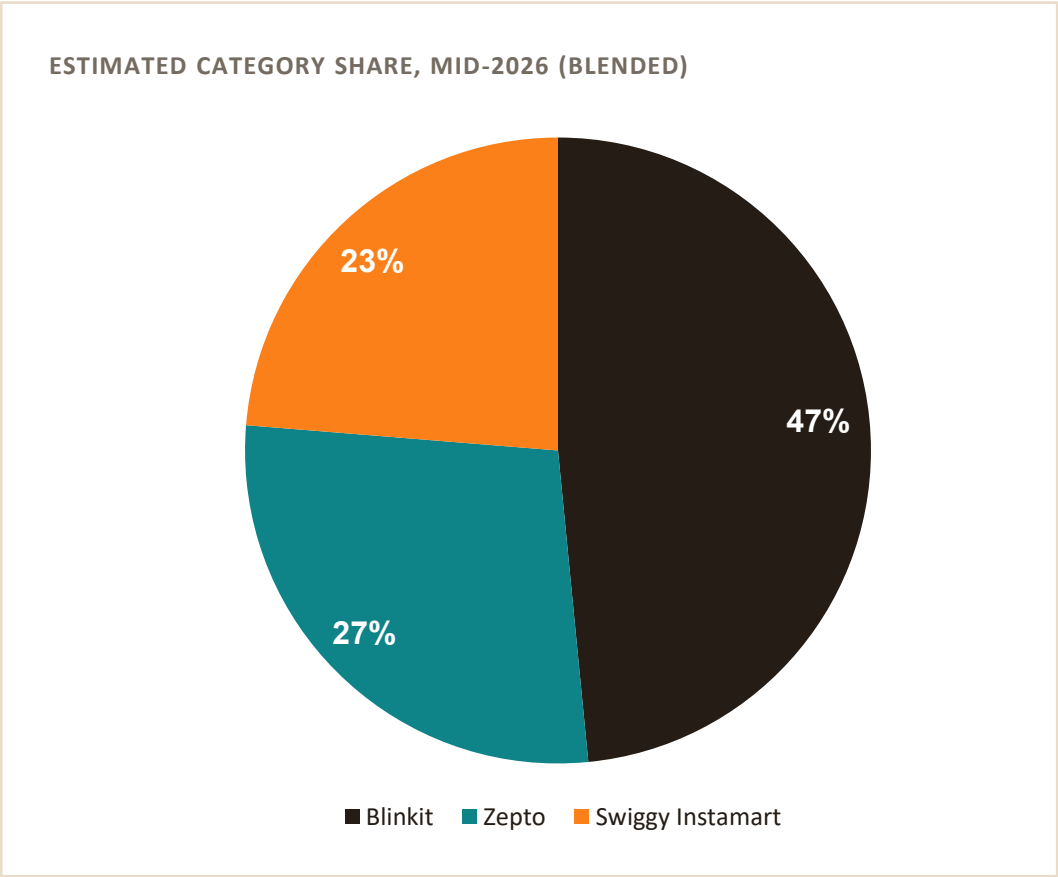
projected annual category growth over the next 3 years

**~10%**

share of branded retail quick commerce is projected to reach by 2030

Source: IMARC Group (India Q-Commerce Market); Redseer via Digital in Asia (Jan 2026 GMV); Bloomberg Intelligence retail-share projection.

# Three Players, One Widening Gap



Source: Digital in Asia / Redseer (category share & Blinkit GOV); Swiggy Q1 & Q4 FY26 shareholder letters and press releases (Instamart figures); Storyboard18 (Zepto platform fees).

## NETWORK DENSITY — THE REAL BATTLEGROUND

| Player           | Dark stores                             | Footprint            |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Blinkit          | ~1,800+, scaling to 3,000 by FY27       | 180+ cities          |
| Swiggy Instamart | 1,143 (Q4 FY26), +75 planned in Q1 FY27 | 129 cities           |
| Zepto            | Estimates diverge (~300–900 range)      | Metro-led, expanding |

### Blinkit : the pace-setter

Overtook Zomato food delivery in mid-2025 to become Eternal's largest business; GOV of ₹11,821 cr in the quarter ended June 2025. Leads on scale, speed and brand recall.

### Zepto : the culture disruptor

Aggressive youth-first marketing, fastest dark-store expansion pace historically, and the first mover on platform fees — a signal the subsidy era is ending for everyone.

### Instamart : the ecosystem player

GOV up 39.8% YoY to ₹7,907 cr (Q1 FY27) || AOV up 33% YoY to ₹700 as non-grocery mix grew from 6.6% to 18.5%. Its edge: distribution inside Swiggy's main app, which carries 27.5M average platform MTUs (Q1 FY27) across food delivery is a built-in cross-sell pool Blinkit and Zepto, as separate apps, don't have.

# How the Category Actually Behaves

## B

### CONSUMER BEHAVIOUR

- 91% awareness among Indian internet users stating that this is no longer a novelty category.
- 50%+ of users ordered at least once in the past week; 39% order 2–3x a month.
- 75% of quick-commerce purchases are unplanned highlighting that the category is impulse-driven, which means media can trigger demand, not just capture it.
- Quick commerce now accounts for roughly two-thirds of all online grocery orders in India.

## S

### SEARCH SIGNALS

- Category-wide on-platform ad spend (sponsored listings, search placements) is estimated at ₹5,000–6,000 cr annually. Brands are chasing search-stage intent inside these apps.
- Generic, high-intent queries (“grocery delivery app,” “10 minute delivery near me”) and branded competitor terms (“blinkit,” “zepto,” “instamart”) are actively contested.
- In-app search-to-purchase conversion is high because intent is already commercial unlike open-web search, which is still mixed-intent.

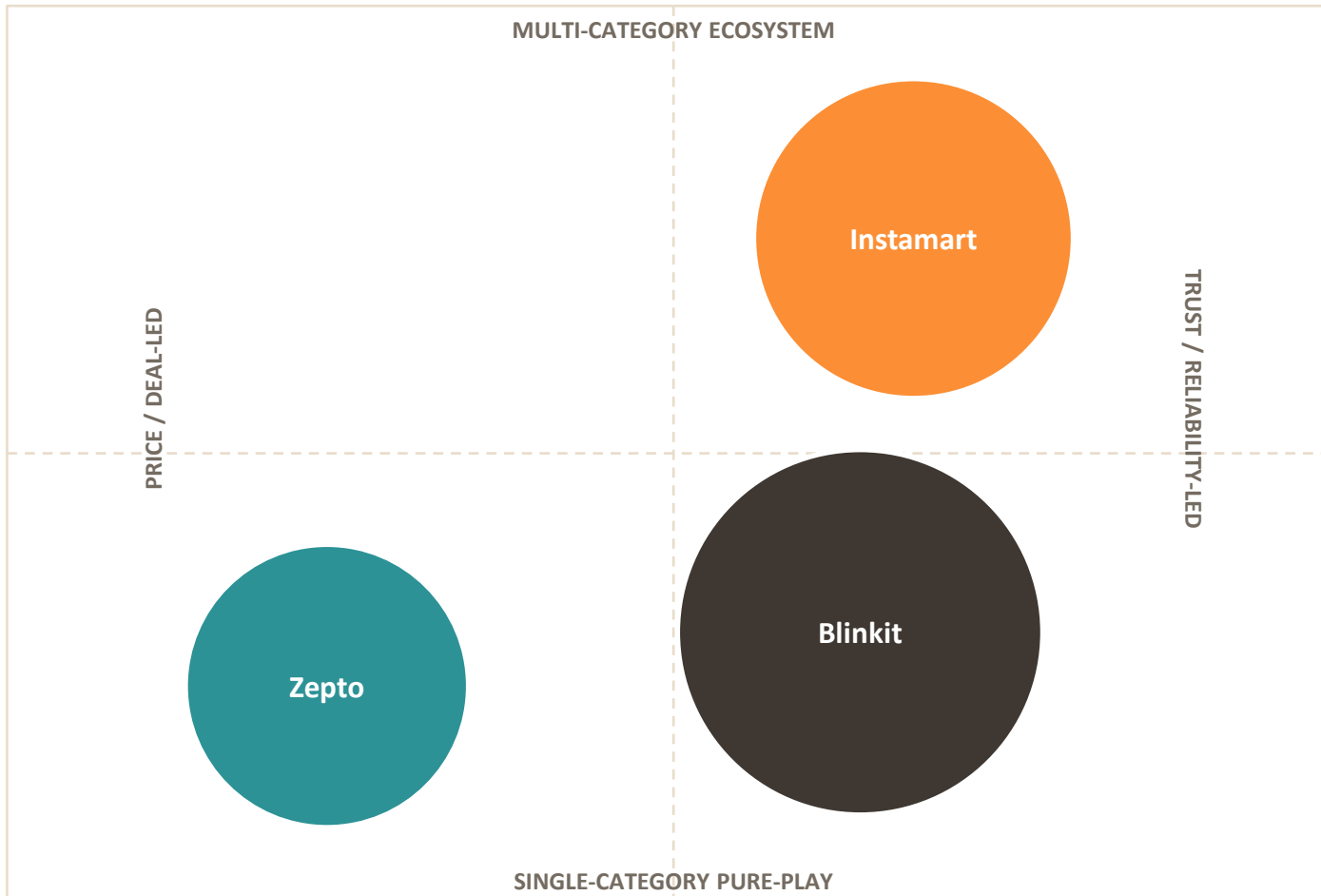
## C

### SOCIAL CONVERSATION

- Backlash and debate around platform fees and surge pricing (Zepto's ₹2 platform fee, ₹15 late-night fee) as free delivery subsidies wind down, value-for-money is now a live conversation.
- Active deal-hunting and coupon-sharing communities driving comparison behaviour across all three apps.
- Recurring debate on 10-minute delivery culture, gig-worker conditions, and dark-store labour are reputational context brand campaigns must be aware of.

Source: Vocal/Journal & Meetanshi quick-commerce statistics roundups (2025–26); Storyboard18 (ad spend & platform fees); GrabOn quick-commerce statistics 2026.

# Competitive Positioning



## THE WHITE SPACE SWIGGY INSTAMART OWN

**Not more MTUs - less friction.  
Instamart's edge is structural, not  
just distributional.**

- ✓ Existing Swiggy food-delivery users already have saved payment methods, addresses and order history. Trying Instamart is a tap, not a fresh sign-up. Blinkit and Zepto, as separate apps, cannot offer that shortcut.
- ✓ Swiggy One members get unlimited free Instamart delivery above ₹149 plus extra discounts on 1,000+ items, a live reason for an existing food-delivery subscriber to add Instamart to their habit.
- ✓ Swiggy has operated continuously since 2014. It is the longest-standing consumer brand of the three which matters while the category is fighting fee and dark-store-labour backlash.

*Positioning inferred from public disclosures and industry commentary (Swiggy shareholder letters & press releases; Storyboard 18; Decodegrowth & StartupFeed platform comparisons). Bubble size is illustrative, not to scale.*



# Beyond “18–30”: The Audience Hypothesis

## PRIMARY AUDIENCE: “URBAN CONVENIENCE NATIVES”

18–30-year-old college students and early-career professionals across Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Pune, Kolkata and Ahmedabad — high smartphone & UPI penetration, live alone or with roommates/family in dense urban pin codes, already run 3–5 delivery and OTT apps, and treat convenience as a default, not a luxury.

### Campus Convenience Seekers

#### 18–22 · Students

- Hostel / PG / shared housing near campus
- High price sensitivity — responsive to first-order and referral discounts
- Group-ordering and split-payment behaviour common
- Peak usage: late evening, exam season, weekends

### Early-Career Professionals

#### 23–30 · 0–6 yrs experience

- Time-poor, EMI-conscious but willing to pay for speed
- Higher AOV; strong candidates for Swiggy One / subscription upsell
- Peak usage: weekday evenings post-work, weekend stock-ups
- More likely to be won on trust, reliability and assortment than price alone

## SUPPORTING DATA POINTS

- 25–34 and 18–24 are consistently the two largest age cohorts on Blinkit and Zepto. The category's core is exactly this range.
- A Thane-city adoption study found 18–30-year-olds to be the dominant quick-commerce cohort, skewing to ₹20,000–₹60,000 monthly income, affordability-conscious, not affluent.
- Category-wide, women aged 25–34 in megacities show 42% higher time-on-app than men. It signal to build gender-balanced creative.

*Source: Fynd & Meetanshi quick-commerce demographic roundups; ResearchGate — “Factors Influencing Consumer Adoption of Quick Commerce in India” (Thane study); VTION–IAMA digital behaviour report, 2026.*

# Why This Audience — And Not a Broader One

1

## Category-defining

18–30 already makes up the two largest age cohorts across every major platform. Winning here is winning the category's actual centre of gravity, not a niche.

2

## Longest runway

This cohort is forming its quick-commerce habits now. The user who chooses Instamart at 22 is the higher-AOV subscriber at 30. Acquisition today compounds into lifetime value.

3

## Cheapest to reach, easiest to move

Digitally native, mobile-first, high time-on-app. This audience is the most cost-efficient to target precisely and the most responsive to app-install and retargeting mechanics.

4

## High propensity to impulse-convert

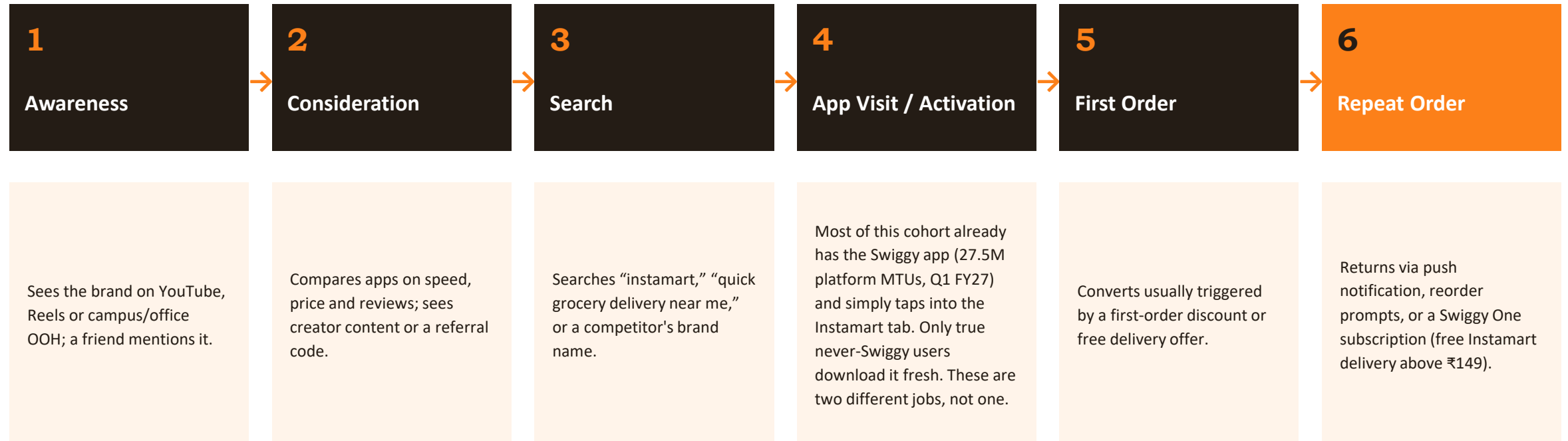
75% of category purchases are unplanned. A digitally native, convenience-first audience converts media exposure into orders faster than any other segment.

5

## The contested battleground

Blinkit and Zepto are fighting hardest for exactly this cohort. Ceding it means ceding the category's future; winning share of it directly slows competitor momentum.

# From First Glance to First Habit



## PLANNING IMPLICATION

Every stage needs a different creative job and a different channel logic. Critically, stage 4 is really two funnels: a low-CAC “activation” job (deep-link existing Swiggy app holders into Instamart) and a higher-CAC “acquisition” job (install for never-Swiggy users) — the media plan and budget on the following slides split spend across both, not just the second.

# Now. Target. The Levers That Close the Gap.

## WHERE WE ARE

- 13.3M average MTU (Q4 FY26), up from 9.8M YoY but new-user addition has collapsed from ~3M to ~0.5M per quarter.
- ~23% category share vs. Blinkit's ~47% (27M+ MTU) more than double Instamart's base.
- 18–30 urban is the category's largest cohort, but Instamart's share of \*new\* acquisition within it is shrinking relative to Blinkit's.

## WHERE WE'RE TARGETING

- +25% QoQ growth in new 18–30 user acquisition, top 8 cities, ahead of the FY27 festive quarter.
- Blended CAC held  $\leq$  ₹180; Day-30 repeat-order rate up 5pp.
- Rebuild the MTU addition run-rate from ~0.5M back toward ~1.5–2M/quarter within two quarters — the first phase of closing the ~10M-user gap to Blinkit's current scale.

## THE LEVERS (MEDIA ONLY)

- Split acquisition spend into activation (deep-link the 27.5M existing Swiggy app base into Instamart) vs. true install (never-Swiggy users) different CAC, different creative, different channel mix.
- Defend and capture search intent (branded + generic) so switchers stop leaking to Blinkit/Zepto at the moment of the click.
- Flight reach channels (YouTube, OTT, Influencers) in bursts timed to the festive intent spike, not spread flat across the quarter.
- Reallocate budget continuously using geo-holdouts and MMM fund what's adding net-new MTUs, defund what's just harvesting existing demand.
- Layer CRM/lifecycle media onto every new acquisition so this quarter's spend shows up as retained MTUs next quarter, not churned ones.

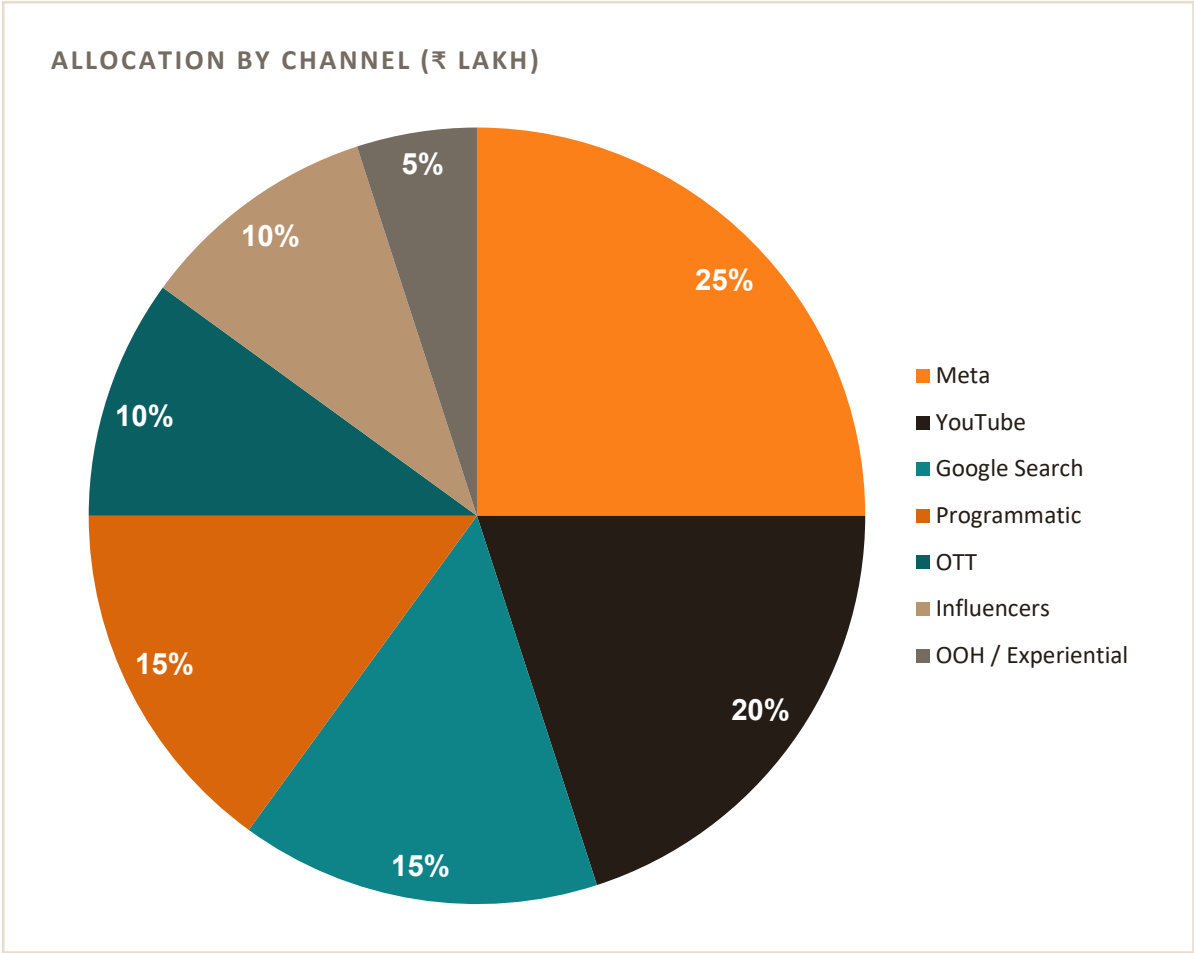
# Channel Role, by Funnel Stage

“Role” = the specific job each channel is bought to do at that stage.

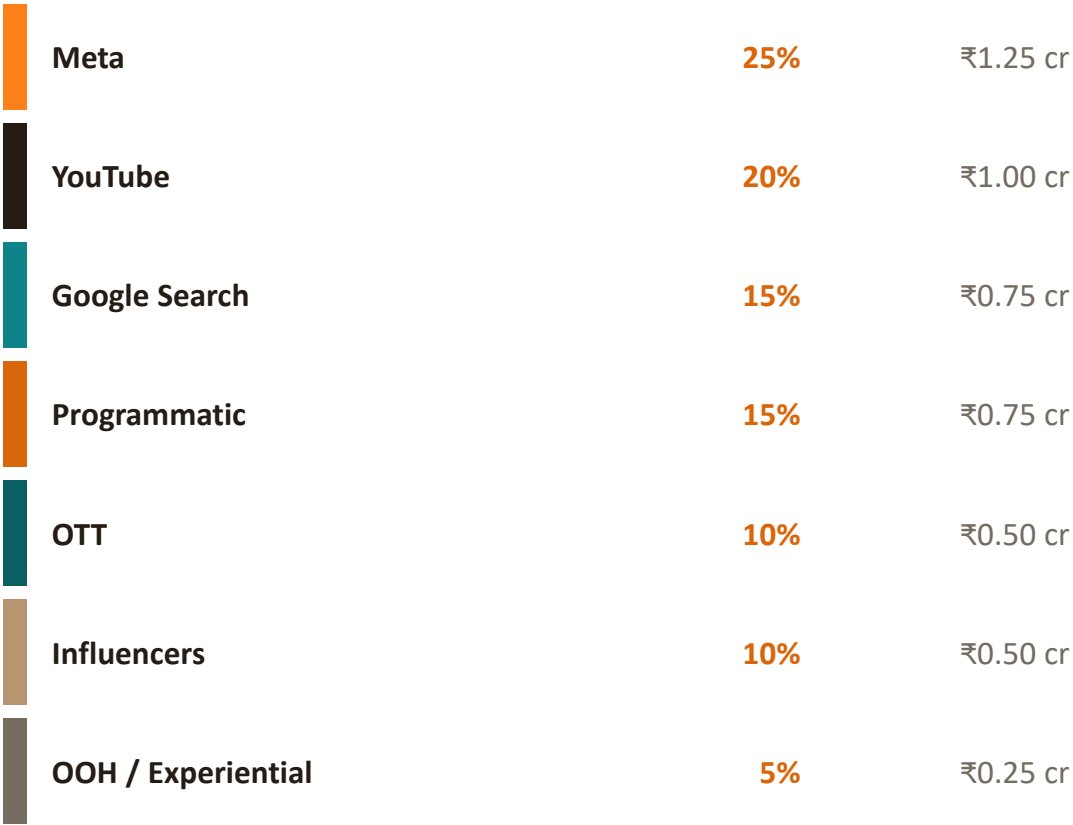
| Funnel Stage    | Objective                                                                 | Primary KPI                    | Channel & Its Role                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Awareness       | Build category & brand salience with 18–30 urban audiences                | Reach, CPM, VTR                | YouTube — broad reach & storytelling · Instagram Reels — daily attention capture · OTT — premium credibility · Campus/metro OOH — physical salience      |
| Consideration   | Drive engagement, seed trust and reviews                                  | Engagement rate, creator reach | Instagram — social proof via saves/shares · YouTube/campus creators — authentic trust-building, ad-skeptic-proof                                         |
| Intent (Search) | Capture and defend active search demand                                   | Impression share, CTR          | Google Search — harvest existing intent + defend the “instamart” brand term from competitor bidding                                                      |
| Conversion      | Turn intent into activation (existing app) or install (new) → first order | CVR, CPI, CAC                  | Meta — lookalikes + deep-link retargeting · Google App (UAC) — install for never-Swiggy users · Programmatic — geo-targeted retargeting near dark stores |
| Retention       | Convert first order into repeat habit                                     | D30 repeat rate, frequency     | CRM push/SMS/WhatsApp — reorder prompts · In-app lifecycle — habit formation · Swiggy One promotion — free-delivery lock-in above ₹149                   |

Reading the table: awareness and consideration create the demand that search then captures; conversion channels harvest it efficiently; retention is where the CAC we just spent starts paying back.

# ₹5 Crore, One Quarter, Seven Levers



QUARTERLY SPEND BREAKDOWN



TOTAL 100% ₹5.00 cr

# Defending Every Rupee

## Meta — 25%

Largest single line because it does the heaviest lifting at conversion: lookalikes off Swiggy's 27.5M platform MTU base (Q1 FY27), precise age/geo/interest targeting to isolate 18–30 metro users, and retargeting of app-visit non-converters. Instagram Reels also carries the bulk of this cohort's daily attention.

## Google Search — 15%

Typically the lowest-CAC channel because demand already exists at the moment of the click. Splits into:  
(a) branded-term defence against Blinkit/Zepto bidding on “instamart,”  
(b) generic category terms to intercept switchers mid-decision.

## OTT — 10%

A smaller, deliberate bet on premium co-viewing context (festive originals, marquee sport) to build credibility beyond pure performance; kept lean given still-maturing OTT-to-app attribution in India.

## OOH / Experiential — 5%

Hyperlocal placements at campuses, tech parks and co-working hubs are exactly where the audience physically clusters with QR-driven install mechanics as a cheap test-and-learn line that also generates earned social content.

## YouTube — 20%

Primary reach engine for a cohort that has largely moved off linear TV. A skippable + Shorts mix balances efficient reach with completion. It doubles as the home for creator-style, high-trust ad creative.

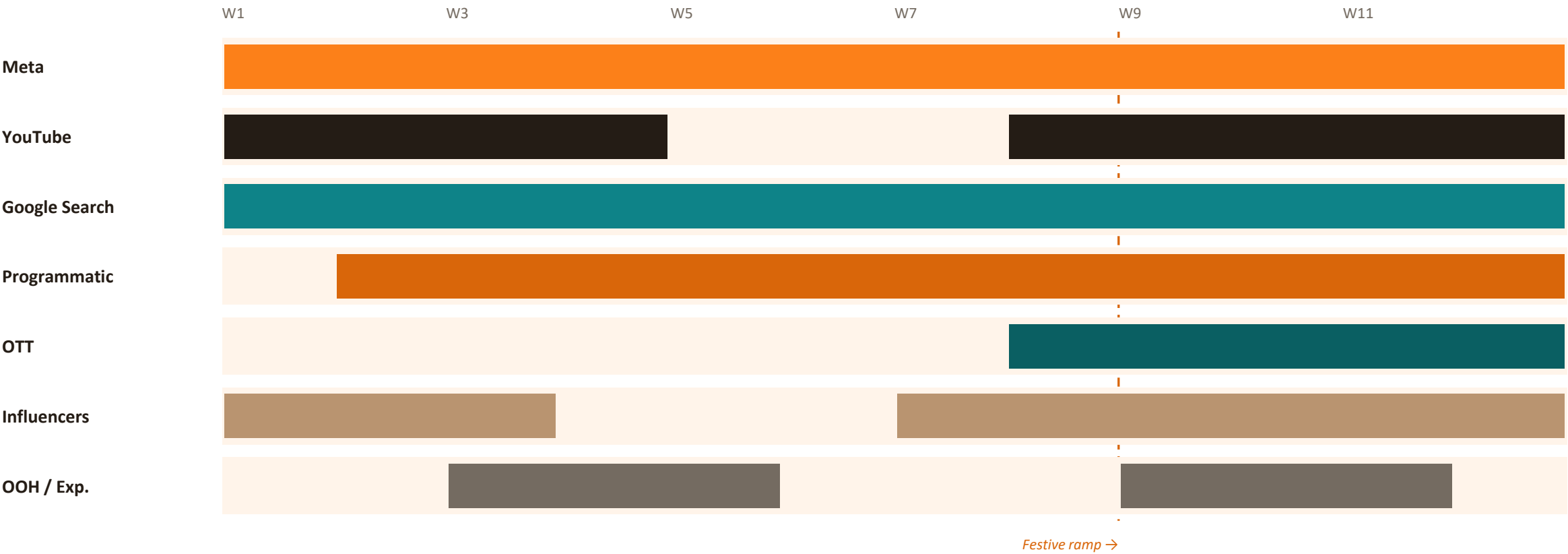
## Programmatic — 15%

The performance backbone outside the walled gardens: app-install networks and open-exchange retargeting, with hyperlocal geo-targeting around dark-store serviceability radii critical in a category where service availability is address-specific.

## Influencers — 10%

Campus micro-creators and young-professional lifestyle creators are the highest-trust voice for an ad-skeptical audience, at CPMs well below paid media and the UGC doubles as paid-creative source material.

# 12-Week Flighting Plan



Always-on: Search, Meta and Programmatic run the full quarter for continuous intent capture. Reach layers (YouTube, OTT, Influencers, OOH) flight in two bursts. A launch pulse (W1–W4) and a heavier festive pulse (W7–W12), to build salience right before peak purchase intent, not spread thin across it.



# Beyond Impressions and Clicks

| Metric                  | What it tells us                                  | Funnel stage         | Directional target                          |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Reach & Frequency       | How many unique people we hit, and how often      | Awareness            | 60–70% reach @ 3–4 avg. frequency / 4 wks   |
| CPM                     | Cost efficiency of building awareness             | Awareness            | ₹150–250 (video) / ₹80–120 (social)         |
| CTR                     | Creative and targeting relevance                  | Consideration        | 1–2% (social) / 4–6% (search)               |
| CPC                     | Cost of an engaged click                          | Intent               | ₹8–15 (search, branded lower)               |
| CVR (install→order)     | Funnel efficiency after the click                 | Conversion           | 12–18%                                      |
| CAC                     | Fully-loaded cost per new acquired user           | Conversion           | ≤ ₹180 blended                              |
| ROAS                    | GOV generated per ₹1 of media, 90-day window      | Conversion/Retention | ≥ 4x by day 90                              |
| Search lift             | Incremental branded search demand created         | Awareness → Intent   | +15–25% vs. baseline weeks                  |
| Incremental conversions | Orders that would not have happened without media | All stages           | Measured via holdout, not attribution alone |

Targets are illustrative planning assumptions, directionally benchmarked against published India digital-advertising and quick-commerce ranges. These are not disclosed Instamart figures.

# How Do We Know Media Caused This?

*Attribution tells you what a user clicked last. It does not tell you whether they would have ordered anyway. This framework is built to answer the harder, more honest question: incrementality.*

## Brand lift studies

Meta & YouTube brand-lift surveys compare exposed vs. unexposed users on aided awareness, message association and purchase intent. It tells us if the awareness layer is actually landing.

## Search lift

Track branded search volume and Search-ads impression share during flight weeks vs. matched baseline weeks. It isolates whether upper-funnel spend is translating into intent, before any conversion happens.

## Geo-holdout experiments

Run full media weight in matched test cities (e.g. Pune, Ahmedabad) while holding out matched-pair control cities (e.g. Jaipur, Chandigarh) with similar category penetration. The gap in new-user growth between test and control is the closest thing to a randomized read we can get at scale.

## Platform holdout / ghost ads

Within Meta and Google, carve out a small % of the eligible audience as an unexposed holdout (PSA/ghost ads). Compare install and order rates of exposed vs. holdout to strip out users who would have converted regardless.

## Conversion attribution (MTA)

MMP-based (AppsFlyer/Adjust) multi-touch attribution for day-to-day optimization. It is useful for reallocating budget within a channel, but treated as directional, not causal, since platforms structurally over-credit their own last touch.

## Marketing Mix Modelling (MMM)

A quarterly/half-yearly regression-based read that decomposes new-user growth by channel spend while controlling for seasonality, discounting, competitor activity and macro factors. This is the long-run, cross-channel view that corrects for what channel-level attribution and even single geo-tests can't see diminishing returns and cross-channel interaction effects and is what we use to defend budget.

# Expected Impact, and What Could Go Wrong

## EXPECTED IMPACT (90 DAYS)

**+25%**

QoQ growth in new users acquired, 18–30 cohort, top 8 cities

**≤ ₹180**

blended CAC, held flat despite the festive-quarter spend ramp

**+5pp**

Day-30 repeat-order rate vs. pre-campaign baseline

**≥ 4x**

90-day ROAS on incremental GOV generated

## RISKS & MITIGATIONS

### Competitor discount escalation

Blinkit/Zepto could counter-offer, inflating category-wide CAC.

*Mitigation: Cap performance spend by CAC ceiling, shift budget to owned/CRM if paid CAC breaches ₹180.*

### Cannibalisation of organic/existing users

Paid media could simply reach people who'd have converted anyway.

*Mitigation: Geo-holdouts and platform ghost-ad tests built in from week 1, not bolted on retrospectively.*

### Dark-store serviceability gaps

Media can drive demand to pin codes Instamart can't yet fully serve.

*Mitigation: Geo-target campaigns to serviceable radii; sequence city-level spend with dark-store density.*

## IN SUMMARY

# Precision beats breadth.

A tightly defined audience, funnel-matched channels, disciplined budget and built-in incrementality testing — not a bigger spend — is how Instamart wins the next phase of this category.

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## KEY SOURCES

- Swiggy Q1 & Q4 FY26 / Q1 FY27 Shareholder Letters and press releases ([swiggy.com/corporate](https://www.swiggy.com/corporate))
- IMARC Group: India Q-Commerce Market Size & Forecast
- Digital in Asia / Redseer — India Quick Commerce 2026 category-share analysis
- Storyboard18 & The Ken: Instamart/Blinkit MTU figures & Q-commerce advertising revenue coverage
- Fynd, Meetanshi & GrabOn: India quick-commerce consumer statistics roundups (2025–26)
- ResearchGate: “Factors Influencing Consumer Adoption of Quick Commerce in India”
- VTION – IMAI : Digital consumer behaviour report, 2026